

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

SOP-FLT-001

Pilot Operations

Medivac.ai Platform

Royal Flying Doctor Service — South Eastern Section

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Document Control

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Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Chief Pilot / DFO	_____	_____	_____
Head of Flying Operations	_____	_____	_____
Safety Manager	_____	_____	_____

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) defines how pilots of the Royal Flying Doctor Service South Eastern Section (RFDS SE) use the Medivac.ai platform to support the full lifecycle of an aeromedical or charter flight — from mission acceptance and pre-flight planning, through in-flight status management, to post-flight documentation and compliance. Medivac.ai is the primary digital operational system for pilots and functions as the single source of truth for aircraft status, journey and technical log entries, crew handovers, and duty records.

The procedures below are written to be consistent with the RFDS SE Operations Manual, the applicable Civil Aviation Safety Authority (CASA) regulations — principally CASR Part 135 (Australian air transport operations — smaller aeroplanes) and the associated fatigue risk management provisions — and the RFDS Pilots Enterprise Bargaining Agreement (EBA) 2025. Where any conflict exists between this SOP and a controlling regulatory or manual document, the controlling document prevails and the discrepancy must be reported to the Chief Pilot.

1.2 Scope

This SOP applies to:

- All line pilots, check-and-training pilots, and Senior Base Pilots (SBP) employed or contracted by RFDS SE.
- All aircraft types operated by RFDS SE across all bases where Medivac.ai is deployed.
- All flight categories managed through Medivac.ai, including primary and secondary aeromedical retrievals, inter-hospital transfers, clinic runs, positioning flights, and charter tasking.
- All phases of a task recorded in Medivac.ai: dispatch and intake, pre-flight, in-flight, and post-flight.

1.3 Out of Scope

This SOP does not replace aircraft-specific Flight Crew Operating Manuals, checklists, or the Aircraft Flight Manual (AFM). Clinical procedures performed by the medical crew, engineering airworthiness determinations, and CASA regulatory interpretation remain governed by their respective controlling documents. Medivac.ai supports these activities but does not supersede them.

1.4 Definitions and Abbreviations

Term	Definition
Medivac.ai	The RFDS SE digital flight operations platform covering dispatch, planning, logs, and duty records.
ORA	Operational Risk Assessment — structured pre-mission risk scoring completed jointly with the Dispatcher.
FRMS	Fatigue Risk Management System, as required under CASA and the RFDS SE Operations Manual.
Tech Log	Technical Log — the CASA-regulated record of aircraft maintenance status, defects, and flight data.
SBP	Senior Base Pilot — the pilot with local operational oversight and currency sign-off authority at a base.

Term	Definition
Dispatcher	The RFDS SE Flight Coordinator responsible for tasking, mission approval support, and crew liaison.
TAS	True Airspeed, expressed in knots (kts).
EBA	Enterprise Bargaining Agreement — the RFDS Pilots EBA 2025 governing duty and rest provisions.

2. Fleet and Performance Reference

The following reference data supports flight planning, fuel calculation, and charter cost estimation within Medivac.ai. Pilots must confirm current performance figures against the applicable Aircraft Flight Manual and the aircraft's Medivac.ai Aircraft Status record before each flight; the values below are planning references only.

2.1 Fleet Performance and Charter Rates

Aircraft Type	True Airspeed	Charter Rate (AUD ex-GST)	Fuel Unit
Beechcraft King Air B200	240 kts	\$4,000 / hr	Pounds (lb)
Beechcraft King Air B350	270 kts	\$4,800 / hr	Pounds (lb)
Pilatus PC-12	285 kts	\$3,200 / hr	Litres (L)
Pilatus PC-24	440 kts	\$6,000 / hr	Litres (L)
Bombardier CL60 Challenger	460 kts	\$9,500 / hr	Litres (L)
Helicopter (Rotary Wing)	180 kts	\$8,500 / hr	Litres (L)

FUEL UNIT CONVENTION

Fuel for both King Air types (B200 and B350) is recorded in pounds (lb). Fuel for the PC-12, PC-24, and CL60 Challenger is recorded in litres (L). Entering fuel in the wrong unit is a reportable data-integrity error — verify the unit displayed by Medivac.ai matches the aircraft type before saving any fuel entry.

2.2 RFDS SE Operating Bases

Medivac.ai is configured for the following RFDS SE bases. Pilots must select the correct base when accepting a mission and confirm that aircraft and crew records are attributed to the correct location.

Base	ICAO	Notes
Dubbo	YSDU	Central West NSW operating base.
Broken Hill	YBHI	Far West NSW operating base.
Bankstown	YSBK	Sydney metropolitan operating base.
Essendon	YMEN	Melbourne / Victoria operating base.
Launceston	YMLT	Tasmania operating base.

BASE CONFIGURATION NOTE

RFDS SE does not operate an Orange base. If a mission or aircraft appears attributed to an Orange base within Medivac.ai, do not accept the task — treat the record as an error and notify the Dispatcher immediately for correction.

3. Pre-Mission Workflow in Medivac.ai

The pre-mission workflow is a sequential set of checks performed in Medivac.ai before a pilot commits to a task. Each step must be completed and, where the module requires it, acknowledged or signed within Medivac.ai. Steps should be actioned in the order presented; where a step cannot be satisfied, the mission must not be accepted until the issue is resolved with the Dispatcher or SBP.

3.1 Mission Acceptance

Open the Dispatch & Intake module and review the full mission details: tasking authority, priority, origin and destination, patient count, estimated departure and arrival times, and any special requirements. Confirm the mission is attributed to the correct base and aircraft type before indicating acceptance. Do not accept a mission with incomplete or inconsistent intake data.

3.2 Aircraft Status Check

Open the Aircraft Status record for the assigned aircraft and confirm serviceability, current fuel state (in the correct unit for the type — see Section 2.1), oil and consumables, and outstanding defect status. Verify the aircraft is not subject to any maintenance hold, deferred defect limitation, or operational restriction that would affect the mission.

3.3 Pilot Handover Board

Review the Pilot Handover Board for any handover left by the previous crew. Note items such as known snags, configuration changes, fuel state on shutdown, positioning of the aircraft, and any operational or environmental information relevant to the next sector.

3.4 Tech & Journey Log Review

Open the Tech & Journey Log and review the most recent entries. Confirm the previous flight was closed out correctly, check for any open (deferred) defects and their limitations, and confirm the airframe and engine hours are current. Any anomaly in the log must be resolved before flight — the Tech Log is a CASA-regulated document (see Section 10).

3.5 Flight Planning

Use the Flight Planning module to enter the route, cruise level, and alternates; calculate fuel required including reserves and contingency; and file the flight plan. Confirm the planned fuel is achievable given the aircraft's current fuel state and any uplift required. Cross-check performance assumptions (TAS, burn) against the AFM for the assigned type.

3.6 Charter Quote

For charter tasking, open the Charter Quote and confirm the cost estimate is consistent with the planned flight time and the applicable charter rate for the type (see Section 2.1, all rates AUD ex-GST). Confirm the quote before the mission proceeds where required by the tasking arrangement.

3.7 Operational Risk Assessment (ORA)

Complete the Operational Risk Assessment jointly with the Dispatcher. Score all applicable risk factors (weather, aerodrome, night operations, crew experience, fatigue exposure, terrain, and mission complexity). A high ORA score requires escalation and approval by the Senior Base Pilot before the mission is accepted (see Section 8.2).

3.8 Crew Rest Calculator

Before accepting the mission, run the Crew Rest Calculator to confirm that legal rest has been met and that the projected duty period will remain within limits for the entire task, including reasonable contingency. If the calculator indicates a breach or marginal outcome, do not accept the mission — refer

to Section 7.

3.9 Mission Briefing

Complete the Mission Briefing: confirm patient details, clinical requirements, weight and loading implications, oxygen and equipment needs, and final routing with the medical crew and Dispatcher. Ensure the briefing is documented in Medivac.ai and that all crew share a common understanding of the plan.

Where a referring facility has provided a referral PDF via the Hospital Referral Portal, the attached document will be visible in the mission record. Pilots should confirm with the Flight Nurse that clinical crew have reviewed the referral prior to departure.

PRE-MISSION GATE

A mission is not considered accepted until steps 3.1 through 3.9 are complete and any required ORA and rest checks pass. If any single gate cannot be satisfied, the pilot must decline or defer the mission and escalate to the Dispatcher and, where relevant, the SBP.

4. In-Flight Procedures (Medivac.ai Support)

Medivac.ai supports the flight in progress by maintaining shared situational awareness across the crew, Dispatcher, and receiving facility. Interaction with the platform in flight must never take priority over the safe operation of the aircraft; status updates are performed at appropriate, low-workload phases of flight and in accordance with sterile-cockpit discipline.

4.1 NSW Flight Map

Use the NSW Flight Map to confirm the planned routing, controlled and restricted airspace, and the position of the aircraft relative to the task. Confirm the displayed route matches the filed flight plan and cross-check any airspace or activity notices before entering affected areas.

4.2 Mission Board

Update the Mission Board status at each phase of the task so the Dispatcher and receiving facility have current information. At a minimum, update status at: departure, top of climb (airborne / en route), arrival at the patient location, patient on board, departure with patient, and arrival at the destination. Accurate, timely status updates reduce coordination workload and support downstream clinical handover.

4.3 Weather Monitoring

Use the Medivac.ai weather integration with the Bureau of Meteorology (BoM) to monitor conditions en route and at the destination and alternates. Reassess the plan if actual or forecast conditions deteriorate below planning minima, and coordinate any diversion or delay with the Dispatcher, updating the Mission Board accordingly.

AVIATE FIRST

Platform interaction is always subordinate to aircraft control, navigation, and communication. If workload is high, defer Medivac.ai updates until a safe opportunity arises. Never allow data entry to compromise flight safety.

5. Post-Flight Documentation

Accurate and timely post-flight documentation in Medivac.ai is a mandatory operational and regulatory requirement. The records created after each flight form the basis of aircraft airworthiness tracking, duty compliance, and the operational audit trail.

5.1 Tech & Journey Log Completion

Complete the Tech & Journey Log entry within 30 minutes of landing. Record flight times, airframe and engine cycles / hours, landings, and any in-flight observations. The Tech Log entry must be accurate and complete before the aircraft is released; incomplete entries must not be left for a subsequent crew to reconstruct.

5.2 Fuel Entry

Record fuel in the correct unit for the aircraft type: pounds (lb) for both King Air types (B200 and B350), and litres (L) for the PC-12, PC-24, and CL60 Challenger. Confirm the unit displayed by Medivac.ai before saving. Record uplift, remaining fuel, and any discrepancy between planned and actual burn.

5.3 Defect Logging

Any defect, snag, or abnormal indication observed during the flight must be entered in Medivac.ai before the next crew takes the aircraft. Clear, specific defect entries allow engineering to assess and, where applicable, defer or rectify the item, and prevent an unserviceable aircraft from being dispatched on a subsequent task.

5.4 Pilot Handover Board Update

Update the Pilot Handover Board for the incoming crew. Record the aircraft's location and configuration, fuel state on shutdown, any open defects and their limitations, and any operational notes relevant to the next sector or duty period.

5.5 Duty & FRMS

Confirm that duty hours are logged correctly in the Duty & FRMS records. Verify that the recorded duty start and end times, flight times, and rest periods accurately reflect the task actually flown, as these records support fatigue management and EBA compliance (see Section 7).

POST-FLIGHT COMPLETION STANDARD

The aircraft is not considered handed over until the Tech Log is complete, fuel and defects are recorded, and the Pilot Handover Board is updated. The 30-minute Tech Log deadline is a firm operational standard.

6. Currency and Training

Pilots are responsible for maintaining and monitoring their own currency and training status. Medivac.ai provides visibility of currency, but the ultimate responsibility for flying only when current and qualified rests with the individual pilot.

6.1 Check & Training Module

Use the Check & Training module to view your own currency status and upcoming checks. Review this regularly to identify expiring items well in advance and to schedule required checks with the check-and-training team through the SBP where necessary.

6.2 Recurrency Requirements

Recurrency requirements are governed by CASA Part 135 and the RFDS Operations Manual. Pilots must satisfy all recurrent training, proficiency, and competency requirements applicable to their role and the types they operate. Medivac.ai reflects these requirements, but the controlling standards are the regulation and the Operations Manual.

6.3 Ratings and Line Check Currency

Pilots must maintain, and confirm within Medivac.ai, currency for:

- Instrument rating — including instrument proficiency checks at the required interval.
- Type rating — for each aircraft type the pilot is authorised to operate.
- Line check — route / line competency checks as required by Part 135 and the Operations Manual.

A pilot must not accept a mission on a type or in a role for which any required currency has lapsed. Where Medivac.ai indicates an expired or imminently expiring item, the pilot must resolve it with the SBP before operating.

7. Fatigue Management

Fatigue management is a shared safety responsibility, but the obligation to declare fitness for duty rests with the individual pilot. RFDS SE operates a Fatigue Risk Management System (FRMS) supported by Medivac.ai.

7.1 FRMS Obligations

Pilots must self-declare fatigue whenever they are, or reasonably expect to become, too fatigued to operate safely. Self-declaration is a professional obligation and is fully supported by RFDS SE; there is no adverse consequence for declaring fatigue in good faith.

7.2 Crew Rest Calculator Usage

Use the Crew Rest Calculator in Medivac.ai to confirm that minimum rest periods have been met before accepting a mission and that the projected duty will remain within limits. The calculator supports, but does not replace, the pilot's own assessment of their fitness for duty.

7.3 EBA Provisions for Rest

Minimum rest and duty provisions are set out in the RFDS Pilots EBA 2025. Pilots must be familiar with the applicable EBA provisions and ensure that rest recorded in Medivac.ai is consistent with those entitlements. Where the EBA and any other reference differ, seek clarification from the SBP or Chief Pilot.

7.4 Escalation

If fatigued, notify the Dispatcher immediately and do not accept the mission. The Dispatcher will arrange alternative crewing or reschedule the task. A fatigued pilot must never commence or continue a duty in a manner that compromises safety.

7.5 FTL Compliance Panel — System-Assisted Oversight

The Medivac.ai FTL Compliance Panel, accessible by the Senior Base Pilot in the SBP Portal (Overview tab), provides automated FTL monitoring across all bases. The panel displays the following risk tiers:

Status	Colour	Condition	Action Required
HARD BLOCK	Red	≤60 min FDP remaining	Pilot must NOT be rostered
2HR WARN	Amber	>60–120 min remaining	SBP review required before assignment
3HR WARN	Yellow	>120–180 min remaining	Monitor; flag to SBP
All Clear	Green	No pilots at risk	No action required

IMPORTANT

The FTL Compliance Panel is a supporting oversight tool for the Senior Base Pilot. It does not replace the individual pilot's self-declaration obligation under Section 7.1. A pilot who is fatigued must declare fatigue regardless of their system-displayed FTL status. Fatigue remains a No-Go item.

The panel also surfaces FDP Warnings at 3-hour, 2-hour, and 1-hour thresholds. A quick link to the full FTL Compliance Engine is available in the panel.

FATIGUE IS A NO-GO ITEM

A self-declaration of fatigue is final for that pilot on that duty. Do not accept, and do not allow pressure to accept, a mission when fatigued. Escalate to the Dispatcher without delay.

8. Senior Base Pilot Responsibilities

The Senior Base Pilot (SBP) provides local operational oversight and is a primary escalation and approval point for the base. The SBP uses Medivac.ai to discharge these responsibilities.

8.1 SBP Portal Usage

Use the SBP Portal for daily crew oversight, including monitoring crew currency, duty and rest status, and aircraft availability across the base. The SBP is responsible for currency sign-off where the role requires it, and for ensuring that only current, qualified crew are rostered to tasks.

FTL Compliance Panel (Overview Tab)

The Overview tab now includes the FTL Compliance Panel, positioned between the leave summary and quick links. The SBP must review this panel:

- At the start of each shift
- Before approving any crew assignment (see also Section 8.2)
- When contacted by Dispatch regarding crew availability

The panel displays all pilots across RFDS SE bases (Dubbo, Broken Hill, Bankstown, Essendon, Launceston) grouped by risk tier. A pilot at HARD BLOCK (≤ 60 min FDP remaining) must not be rostered under any circumstances — this is a legal obligation under CASR Part 121/135 FTL provisions. Pilots at 2HR WARN should be treated as an escalation trigger for proactive crew planning: contact the pilot, assess whether the mission can be reallocated, and document the decision.

Use the 'View full FDP/Duty tab' button in the panel to access the detailed flight-duty period and rest record for any individual pilot. The quick link to the FTL Compliance Engine provides full reporting and audit trail access.

8.2 Mission Approval for High ORA-Score Flights

The SBP is the approval authority for missions returning a high Operational Risk Assessment score (see Section 3.7). Such missions must not proceed without the SBP's review and documented approval in Medivac.ai, including any additional mitigations or conditions imposed.

8.3 Escalation Point for Dispatcher

The SBP is the escalation point for the Dispatcher on operational matters arising at the base, including crewing constraints, marginal rest outcomes, aircraft serviceability decisions, and any situation where a mission cannot proceed as tasked. The SBP coordinates resolution and, where necessary, escalates further to the Chief Pilot / Director of Flight Operations.

9. Emergency and Abnormal Procedures

In any emergency or abnormal situation, the pilot's first priority is the safe operation of the aircraft. Medivac.ai is used to record and communicate the event once the aircraft and occupants are safe; it is never a distraction from managing the situation.

9.1 In-Flight Emergency

Apply the standard priority: Aviate, Navigate, Communicate. Fly the aircraft, action the applicable checklist and emergency procedures, and communicate with air traffic services and the Dispatcher as workload permits. Update Medivac.ai on landing — do not attempt to record the event in the platform while managing the emergency.

9.2 Mission Abort

If a mission must be aborted, notify the Dispatcher immediately so that alternative arrangements can be made for the patient and task. Once safe, document the abort in Medivac.ai, including the reason, the decision point, and the outcome, so the operational record is complete and accurate.

9.3 Safety Occurrence Reporting

Report any safety occurrence using the Audit & Reports function in Medivac.ai, or by notifying the Safety Officer directly. Timely, honest reporting supports the RFDS SE safety management system and any external reporting obligations. Reporting a safety occurrence in good faith is expected and supported.

SEQUENCE OF ACTIONS

Secure the aircraft and occupants first. Communicate with air traffic services and the Dispatcher. Record in Medivac.ai only when safe to do so — typically on the ground after the event.

10. Compliance

Medivac.ai records form the primary operational record for RFDS SE flight operations. The accuracy, completeness, and timeliness of entries directly affect airworthiness management, duty and fatigue compliance, charter accounting, and the operator's ability to demonstrate regulatory compliance.

Pilots are responsible for the accuracy of all entries they make in Medivac.ai. Entries must reflect what actually occurred; they must not be estimated where actual data is available, back-dated, or altered other than through the platform's controlled correction process.

Tech Log entries are CASA-regulated documents. They must be completed accurately and within the required timeframes (see Section 5.1), and they must not be modified except in accordance with the approved procedure. Falsification, omission, or careless completion of a Tech Log entry is a serious matter with regulatory and safety consequences.

10.1 Records and Retention

Operational records created in Medivac.ai are retained in accordance with the RFDS SE Operations Manual and applicable CASA requirements. Pilots must not delete or attempt to circumvent the platform's record-keeping controls. Any suspected data error, loss, or integrity issue must be reported to the SBP and the Safety Officer.

10.2 Pilot Compliance Responsibilities

- Complete all required Medivac.ai entries accurately and within the specified timeframes.
- Use the correct fuel unit for the aircraft type and confirm the unit before saving (Section 2.1).
- Ensure Tech Log and defect entries are complete before the aircraft is released or handed over.
- Maintain and confirm currency before operating, and never operate outside currency or qualification.
- Self-declare fatigue and use the Crew Rest Calculator before accepting any mission.
- Report safety occurrences promptly via Audit & Reports or the Safety Officer.

REGULATORY STATUS

This SOP supports, and must be read together with, the RFDS SE Operations Manual, CASR Part 135, the applicable FRMS requirements, and the RFDS Pilots EBA 2025. Where a controlling document differs, the controlling document prevails. This document is UNCONTROLLED WHEN PRINTED.

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